

Lecture 9

Global Governance and EU Regional Integration

20 April 2026– BAIS
International Relations



**Universiteit
Leiden**
The Netherlands

Sarah Wolff

Professor in International Studies and
Global Politics

Institute of History
University of Leiden

s.wolff@hum.leidenuniv.nl
[@profsarahwolff](https://twitter.com/profsarahwolff)

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Key Debates and Readings

Questions to be considered:

- What role does 'regionalism' bring to the study of international relations?
- What are the main theories of regional integration?
- Why has the EU been for so long as a Normative Power?

Required readings:

1. Heywood, A., & Whitham, B. (2023). Global politics (3rd ed., Chapter 21 EU Regionalism and Global Politics London: Red Globe Press)
2. Zwolski, K. (2025) 'Pan-Europe Revisited: Inter-War Debates and the EU's Pursuit of Geopolitical Power', *Journal of Common Market Studies*, <https://doi.org/10.1111/jcms.70070>

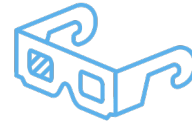
Content



**Regionalism
why and How**



**The European
Union**



Theories



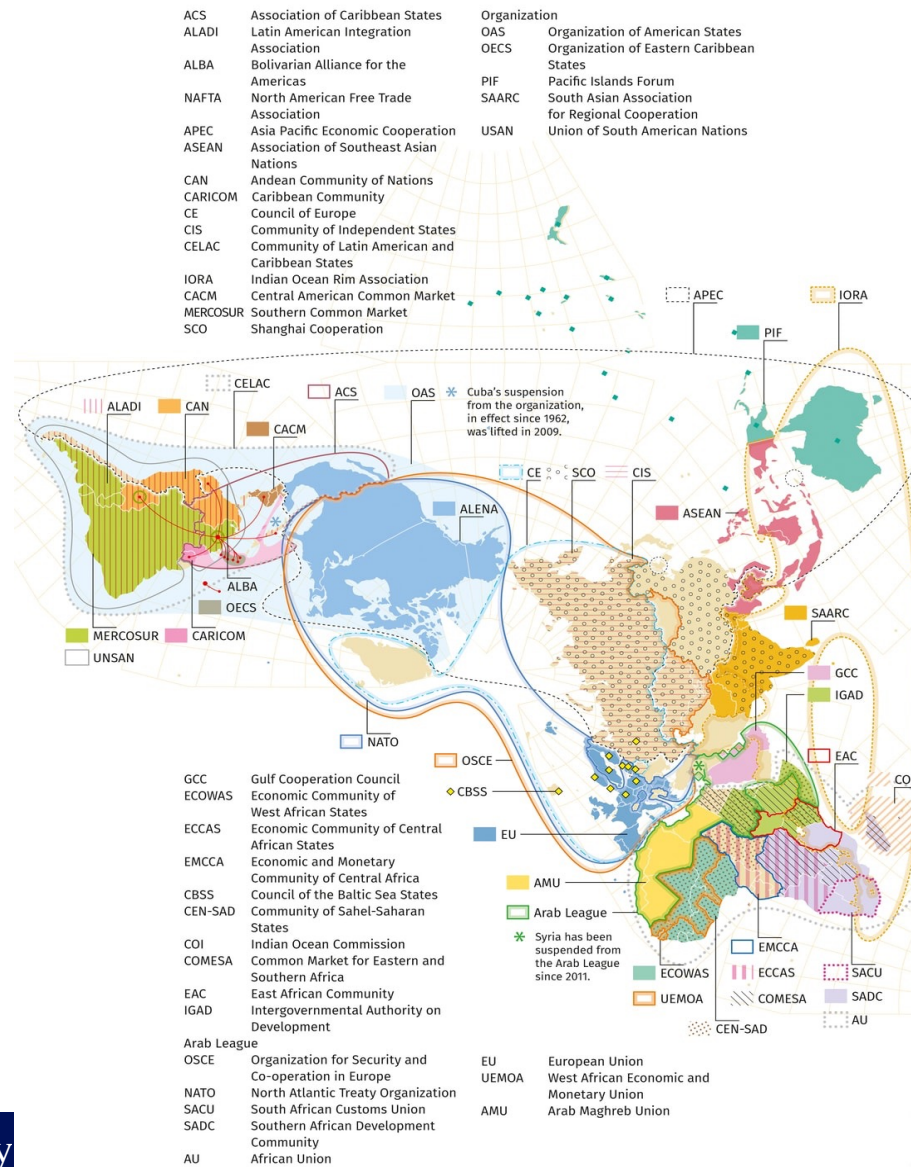
Global Europe

What is a region?

<https://ourworldindata.org/world-region-map-definitions>

The explosion of regional organisations

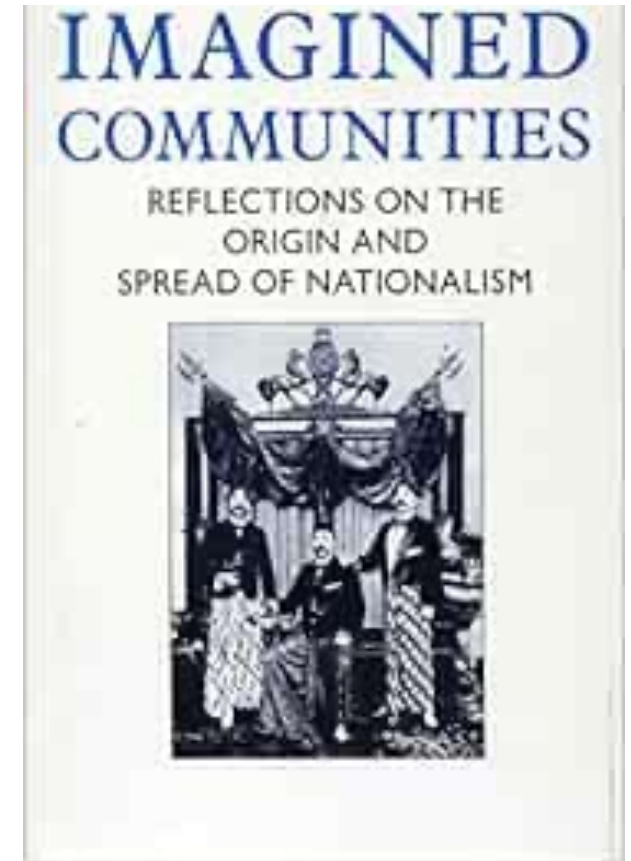
Source: [Science Po, 2018](#)



Regionalism Why and How (Acharya)

- What is common among the peoples and political units that inhabit a given geographical and geopolitical space
- Cantori and Spiegel (1970): **geographical proximity**, international interaction, common bonds (including ethnic, cultural, social and historical) and a sense of regional identity that may be enhanced by attitude and the role of external actors
- **Political economy** perspective: regions are by-products of globalization
- **Constructivism**: shared identity, imagined, socially constructed

According to P. Katzenstein 'regional identities complement, rather than replace, evolving state and national identities'.



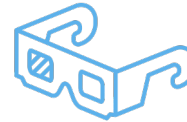
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Regionalism why
and How



**The European
Union**



Theories



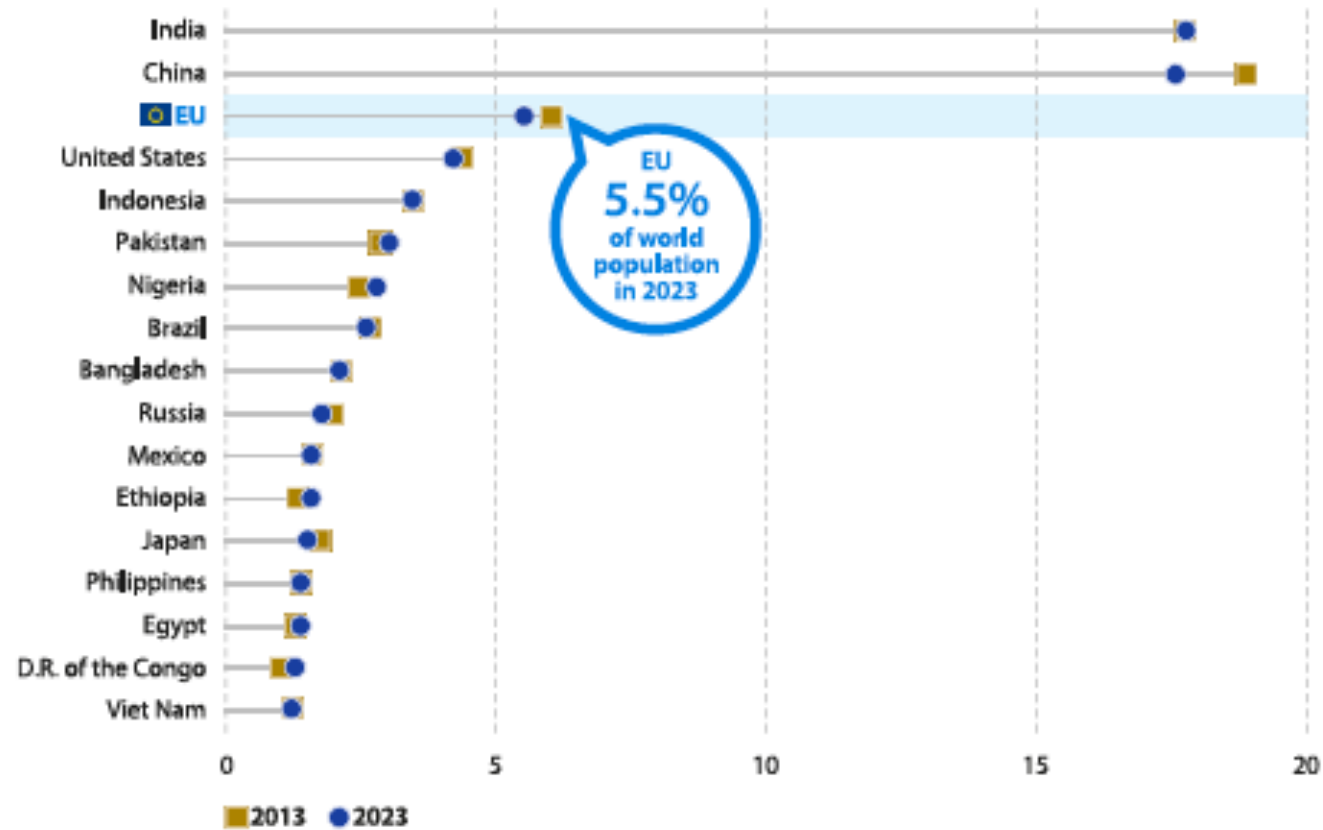
Global Europe

The EU in numbers

- **27 member states** different size: France biggest and Malta smallest
- **447 million people** (3rd in world after China and India)
(Germany 84 million, Malta 545.000)
- **EU Budget:** €199 billion 2025 (commitments) (Netherlands: €457 billion)
- **Second largest economy in the world** with \$20.29 trillion in nominal terms for 2025
- **21 countries in the Eurozone**

Population

(% of world population, 2013 and 2023)

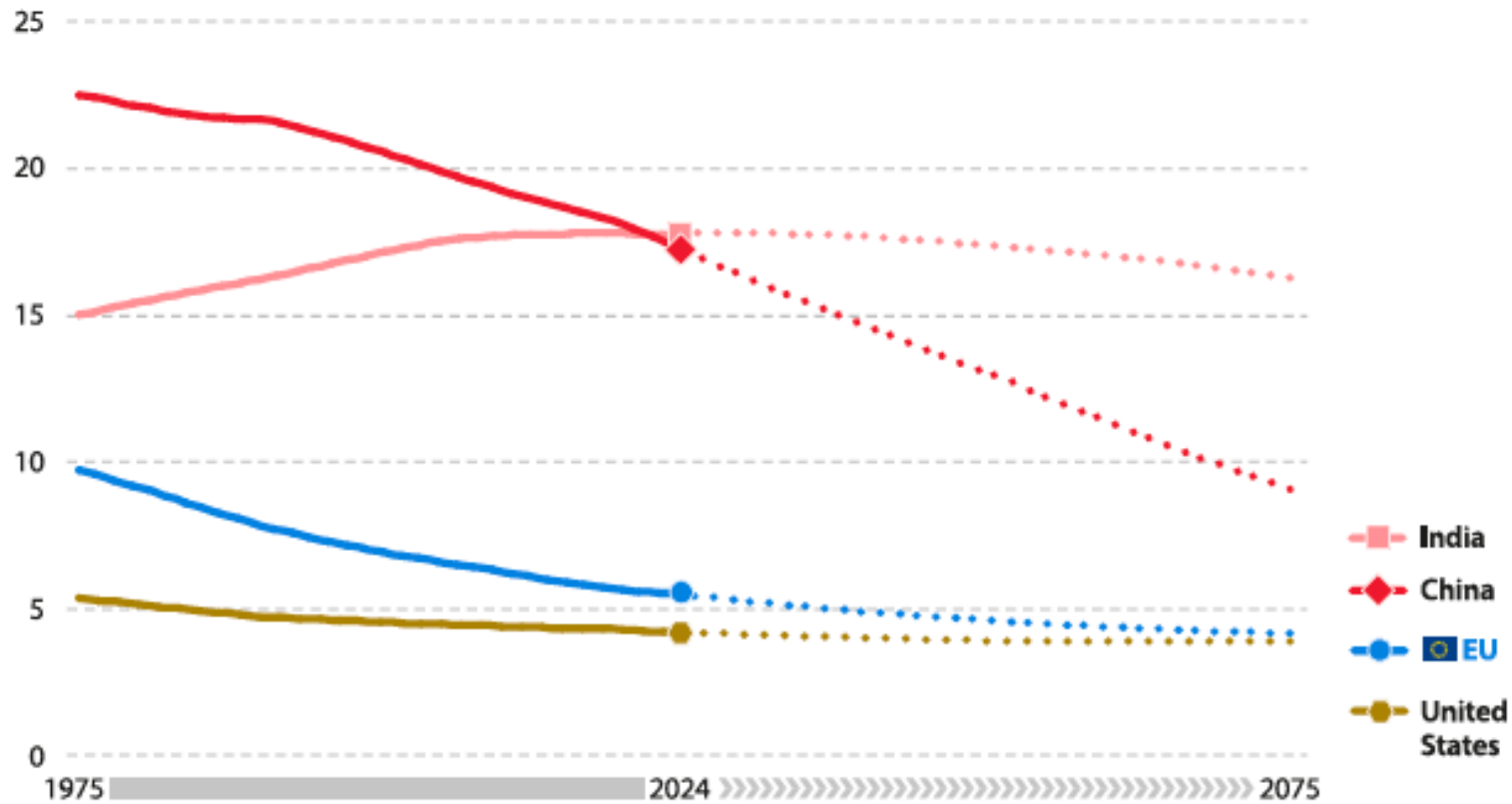


Note: average population. Data are presented for the EU and non-EU countries with a population of at least 100 million people in 2023.

Source: Eurostat (online data code: [demo_qind](#)) and the United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs, Population Division ([World Population Prospects 2024](#))

Population

(% of world population, 1975–2075)



Note: average population. Projections start in 2024. Data are presented for the EU and the 3 most populous non-EU countries.

Source: Eurostat (online data codes: [demo_gInd](#) and [proj_23np](#)) and the United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs, Population Division ([World Population Prospects 2024](#))

diversity

Do you know...

Which EU country has
the biggest population under 15?

Which EU country has the largest share

of non-nationals in its total population?

Which country trusts the European Union the most?

What percentage of people live in rural areas in the EU?

What percentage of people in the EU speak more
than one language?

- 25.2% in 2021 (35.9% in towns and 38.9% in cities)
- 64.6% in 2016

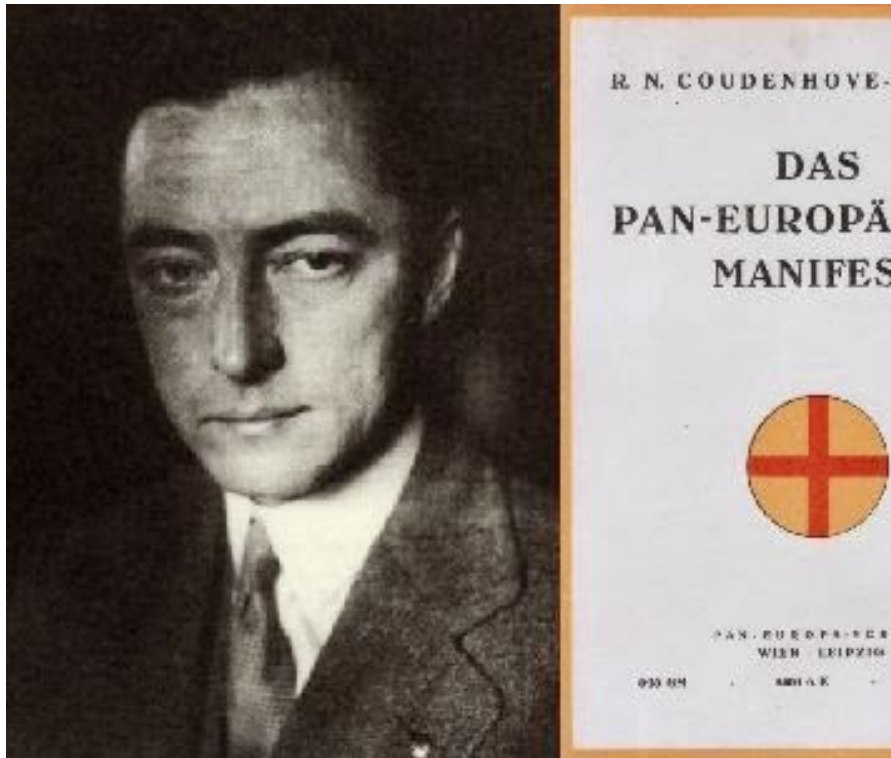
Luxembourg: 47% in 2021

France: 11,991,684 in 2021

Malta shows the
highest proportion
(71%), France the
lowest (34%)

Pan-Europeanism

*'Europe is uniting without the majority of Europeans being ready for it'
'Europe becomes one on the level of parliaments and state chancelleries
but not within the hearts of Europeans'*





Schuman declaration © European Communities, 1950*

1950: SCHUMAN DECLARATION

On 9 May 1950 the French Minister of Foreign Affairs, Robert Schuman, held a press conference. He called upon other European countries to pool coal and steel resources. As coal and steel are necessary components for arms production, he hoped this cooperation would render future war impossible. On top of that, coal and steel were also very important in rebuilding the continent after the war.



Polling office in the European elections, Belgium © European Communities, 1979

1979: FIRST DIRECT ELECTIONS FOR THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT

The citizens of the European Communities directly elected their representatives in the European Parliament for the first time in June 1979. At the time there were nine countries, electing 410 members of Parliament for the period of 1979-1984.



World War II

Europe was in ruins after World War II. The war destroyed cities, roads and much of Europe's industry. Europe's economy was in shambles. The war was also devastating on a human scale: 55 million people worldwide were killed, 35 million people were injured and 190 million people fled their homes. The cry for peace was louder than ever before.



1951: TREATY ESTABLISHING THE EUROPEAN COAL AND STEEL COMMUNITY

France, Germany, Italy, Belgium, the Netherlands and Luxembourg reacted positively to Robert Schuman's declaration. These six countries signed the Treaty of Paris in 1951. The European Coal and Steel Community (ECSC) entered into force in 1952.



© European Union, EP

1957: TREATIES OF ROME: EEC AND EURATOM TREATIES

The first six countries wanted an even stronger economic integration. Therefore they signed two new treaties in 1957: the EEC treaty and Euratom, also known as the Rome Treaties.

- **European Economic Community (EEC):** The countries agreed to gradually turn their separate economies into a common market, starting with a customs union. This treaty marked the beginning of the cooperation in agriculture, fisheries, harbour policy and transport policy.
- **Euratom:** This cooperation in nuclear energy aimed at joint research into the possible civilian applications of nuclear energy.

The Rome Treaties entered into force in 1958.



Signing of the Rome Treaties © AEI, 1957 - Source: EC Audiovisual Service



1986: THE SINGLE EUROPEAN ACT

Thirty years after the countries had decided to establish a common market (the Rome Treaties), it was still not in effect. With the Single European Act the Member States decided that all obstacles to trade and free movement had to be removed (signed in 1986, into force in 1987).

1993: OPEN BORDERS

On 1 January 1993 the internal borders of the Member States of the European Union "disappeared": The Single Market with free movement of persons, goods, services and capital came into effect.



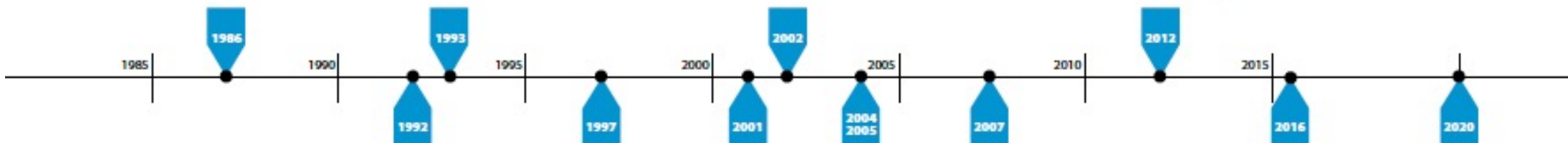
2002: INTRODUCTION OF THE EURO

The euro was introduced into the banking system in 1999. But people only started using euro coins and notes on 1 January 2002.



2012: THE EU WINS THE NOBEL PEACE PRIZE

This prize was awarded to recognise European efforts towards peace, reconciliation, democracy and human rights.



1992: TREATY ON EUROPEAN UNION-MAASTRICHT TREATY

The Maastricht Treaty marked the actual beginning of cooperation on a political level, alongside the existing economic integration. A new name was given to the former European Communities: the European Union. The "new" European Union consisted of three main pillars:

1. **Economic integration:** The Member States decided to enhance economic integration and to establish a common **European currency: the euro**.
 2. Cooperation on **foreign and security policy**.
 3. Cooperation on **home/domestic affairs** and justice.
- This treaty was signed in 1992 and entered into force in 1993.



1997: TREATY OF AMSTERDAM

With the prospect of EU enlargement towards Eastern Europe, the EU needed to be ready for a significant rise in the number of Member States. A reform of the decision-making process was needed: fewer decisions based on unanimity and more on majority voting. The first attempt to change this was with the Amsterdam Treaty (signed in 1997, into force in 1999). The treaty however did not live up to this expectation.

2001: TREATY OF NICE

With the accession date of the new countries coming closer, a second attempt to reform the European Union was made in Nice (signed in 2001, into force in 2003). It also failed to make the EU decision making easier.

2004-2005: THE EUROPEAN CONSTITUTION

A third attempt was made with the European Constitution in June 2004. Because of the

2007: LISBON TREATY

The Lisbon Treaty succeeded in changing the functioning of the EU institutions. Making decisions at European level became easier. The new rules entered into force in December 2009 and determine how the EU still functions today.



Heads of state in Lisbon, for the signing of the Treaty.

2016: UK REFERENDUM ON LEAVING THE EU

On 23 June 2016, most British citizens and some other UK residents were asked this question: "Should the UK remain a member of the European Union or leave the European Union?" 51.9 % voted to leave and 48.1 % voted to remain, triggering negotiations on the UK's exit from the European Union and making it the first country ever to leave.

Referendum on the United Kingdom's membership of the European Union

Majority won by putting a cross (X) in the box next to your choice

2020: THE UK OFFICIALLY WITHDRAWS FROM THE EU

The UK officially left the European Union on 31 January 2020, after three years of negotiations.





10/4
1951

1951 THE FIRST SIX

Six countries founded the European Coal and Steel Community and later, in 1957, the European Economic Community and Customs Union:

France
Germany
Italy
Belgium
the Netherlands
Luxembourg



1973

ACCESSION OF DENMARK, IRELAND AND THE UNITED KINGDOM

The success of the European Economic Community attracted other European countries. Denmark, Ireland and the United Kingdom joined in 1973. There were also ongoing negotiations with Norway at the time, but the Norwegian people voted against membership in a referendum.



1/1
1973

1981

ACCESSION OF GREECE

Greece had recently shaken off a military dictatorship. With the accession of Greece, the then-member states wanted to support the newly-installed democracy. Economic arguments were in play as well: Greece was an interesting new market.



1/1
1981

1989

FALL OF THE BERLIN WALL

On 9 November 1989 the Berlin Wall fell. "This historical event is one of the major milestones marking the end of the division between West and east Europe". There was now the possibility for newly emerging democracies in Eastern Europe to join the European cooperation. Therefore, in 1993, the Member States determined the **conditions** to be met by new countries in order to qualify for accession:

- Be a European country (geographically or historically)
- Respect the rule of law
- Have a well-functioning market economy
- Be a stable democracy
- Respect human rights
- Implement all existing EU rules and regulations, the so-called *acquis communautaire*

1990

UNIFICATION OF GERMANY

East and West Germany wanted to be reunited as a country. The other member countries agreed to unification, on the condition that Germany was thoroughly embedded in the European cooperation, both economically and politically.



2004

ACCESSION OF CYPRUS, THE CZECH REPUBLIC, ESTONIA, HUNGARY, LATVIA, LITHUANIA, MALTA, POLAND, SLOVAKIA, AND SLOVENIA

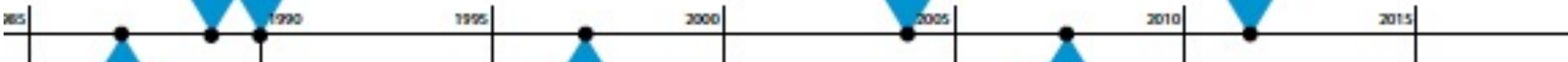
On 1 May 2004, 10 new countries joined the EU. This brought the total number of member countries up to 25.



2013

ACCESSION OF CROATIA

On 1 July 2013 Croatia joined the EU. Croatia joined as the 28th Member State of the European Union.



1986

ACCESSION OF SPAIN AND PORTUGAL

Support for democracy and economic motives also played an important role in the accession of Spain and Portugal. Spain had just rid itself of the dictator Franco, and Portugal had also put an end to the dictatorship of Salazar.



1995

ACCESSION OF SWEDEN, FINLAND AND AUSTRIA

With the accession of Sweden, Finland and Austria, the EU now had 15 Member States. Norway made a second attempt at accession, but again the Norwegian people voted against this, in a referendum.



2007

ACCESSION OF ROMANIA AND BULGARIA

Bulgaria and Romania joined in 2007. Their accession increased the number of member states to 27.



European Union mulls future expansion

The current security situation in Europe has given EU enlargement a new lease of life, as 10 countries wait to join the 27-member bloc

EU members by joining date

1957-1995 2004-13

Candidate countries

Official candidate status
Year granted

Potential candidate

UK
EU member
1973-2020

Bosnia-Herz
2022

Montenegro
2010

*No active accession talks

Albania 2014

North Macedonia 2005

RUSSIA

Serbia 2012

Moldova 2022

Ukraine
2022

Georgia

Kosovo

Türkiye*
1999

ALBANIA

Population 2.8 million
GDP \$18.9 billion



MONTENEGRO

Population 0.6 million
GDP \$6.1 billion



BOSNIA-HERZEGOVINA

Population 3.2 million
GDP \$24.5 billion



NORTH MACEDONIA

Population 2.1 million
GDP \$13.6 billion



GEORGIA

Population 3.7 million
GDP \$24.6 billion



SERBIA

Population 7.2 million
GDP \$63.5 billion



KOSOVO

Population 1.8 million
GDP \$9.4 billion



TÜRKİYE

Population 85.3 million
GDP \$906 billion



MOLDOVA

Population 3.3 million
GDP \$14.4 billion



UKRAINE

Population 39.7 million
GDP \$161 billion



Sources: European Commission, Reuters, World Bank, Worldometer

© GRAPHIC NEWS

More than an International Organisation

Supranational
decision-making
(Cie, QMV, EP)

EU is a legal
entity

European legal
order –supremacy
and direct effect

Elected European
Parliament

Scope and volume
of Common
policies
(europeanisation)

Internal Market
(plus monetary
Union)

Less than a State

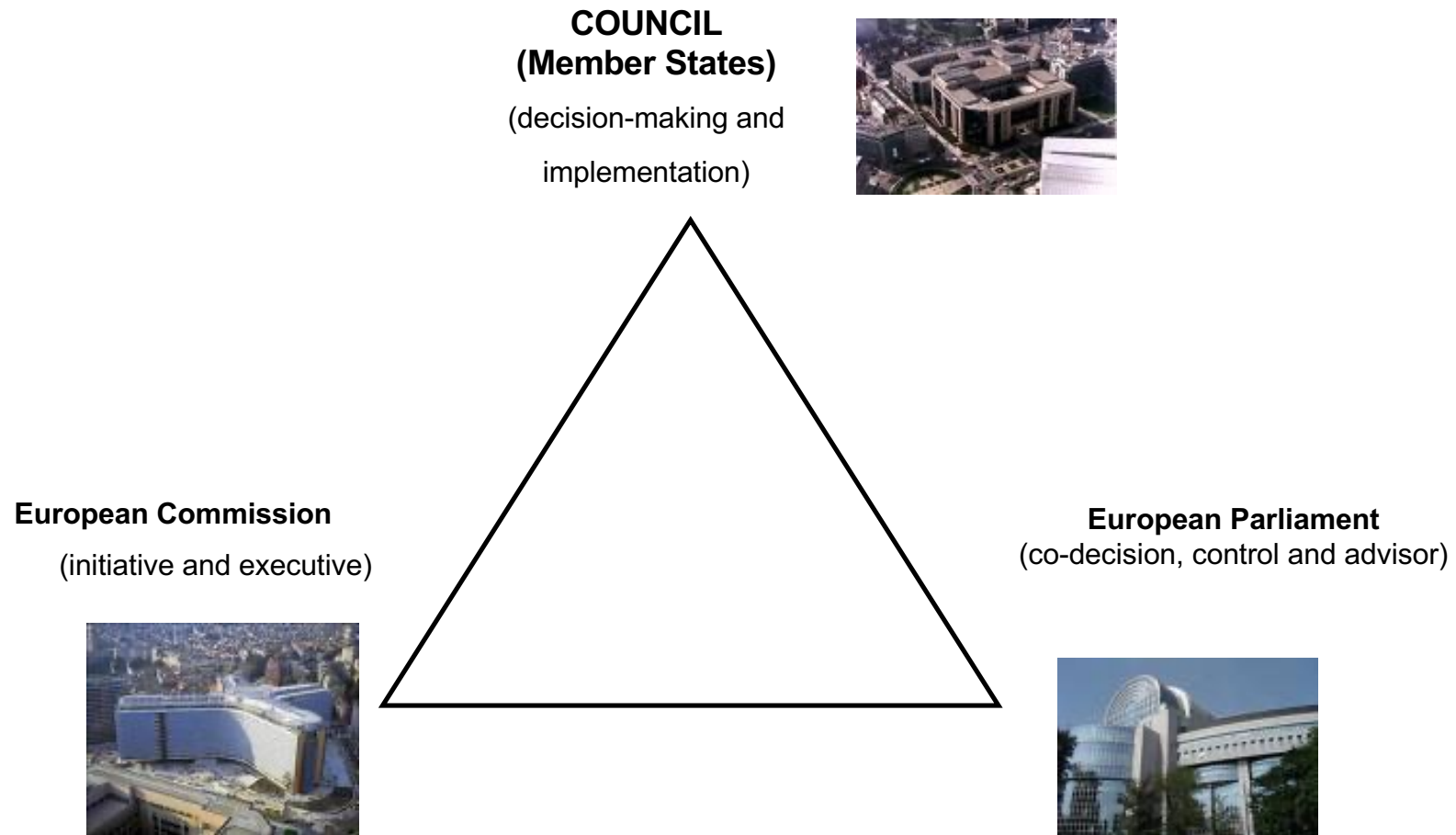
Limited sovereignty
(only as far as the
Treaty allows)

No clear-cut territory

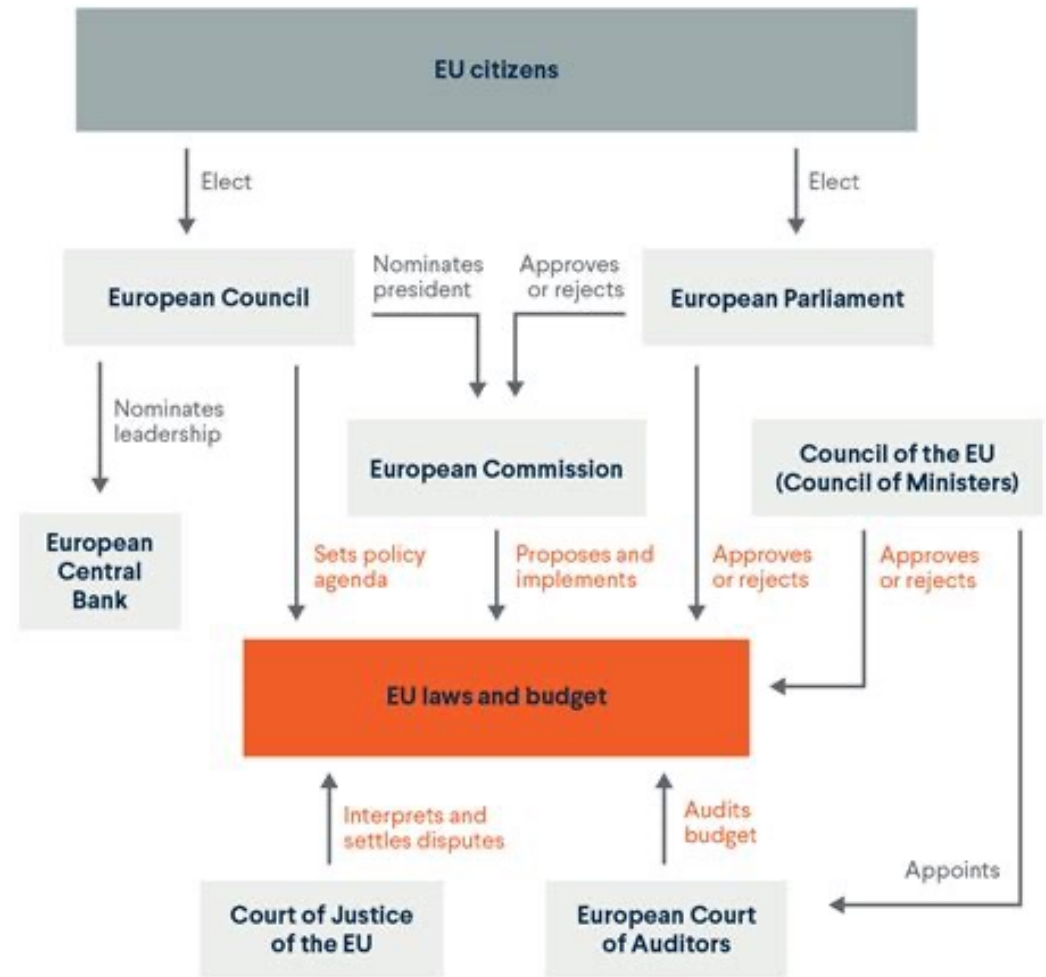
Not one
population/language
but many
nationalities (weak
European identity)

No Power monopoly
(army, taxes, police)

The Institutional Triangle



How Do the EU Institutions Work Together?



Source: European Union.

COUNCIL OF
FOREIGN
RELATIONS

EU institutions

The Institutions of the European Union

EXECUTIVE

European Council

The EU's 27 national leaders

Sets policy agenda

European Commission

27 commissioners, nominated by the European Council and approved by Parliament

Proposes and implements legislation

LEGISLATIVE

European Parliament

705 members, directly elected by EU citizens

Approves or rejects legislation

Council of the European Union (Council of Ministers)

27 national ministers, grouped by policy area

Approves or rejects legislation

JUDICIAL

Court of Justice of the European Union

Two courts, with judges appointed jointly by national governments

Interprets EU law and settles disputes

European Court of Auditors

27 members, appointed by the Council of Ministers

Audits budget

FINANCIAL

European Central Bank

President and executive board appointed by the European Council

Maintains the stability of the euro and oversees the European financial system

Source: European Union.

COUNCIL on
FOREIGN
RELATIONS

EU Members and Institutions

Institutional headquarters

- 1. Brussels**
Commission, Council of Ministers,
European Council, Parliament
- 2. Frankfurt**
Central Bank
- 3. Luxembourg City**
Secretariat of the Parliament, Council
of Ministers, Court of Justice, Court
of Auditors
- 4. Strasbourg**
Parliament



Source: European Union.

Main steps to EU accession



1 Country submits an **application** to the Council (EU Member States).



2 The Commission submits an **Opinion** on the application.



3 EU Member States decide unanimously to grant the country **candidate status**.



4 After conditions are met, Member States (unanimously) agree to **open the accession negotiations**.



5 The Commission proposes a draft **negotiating framework** as a basis for the talks. Accession negotiations formally start once Member States agree on the negotiating framework.



6 During negotiations, which are structured according to **clusters and chapters**, the country prepares to implement EU laws and standards.



7 Once negotiations on all areas are finalised, the Commission gives its **Opinion on the readiness** of the country to become a Member State.



8 Based on this Opinion, EU Member States decide unanimously to **close the accession negotiations**. The European Parliament must also give its consent.

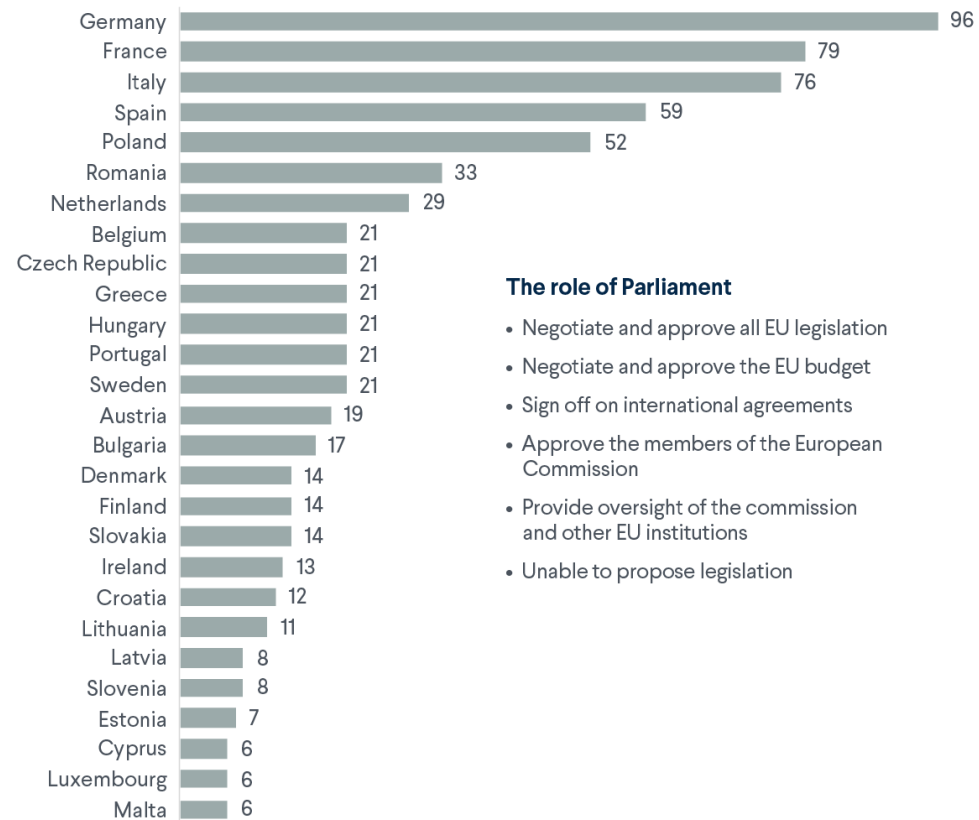


9 All EU Member States and the candidate country **sign and ratify an Accession Treaty** which enables the country to become an EU Member State.

The European Parliament

Parliament is made up of 705 members, each directly elected by EU citizens every five years.

Members of Parliament by country



The role of Parliament

- Negotiate and approve all EU legislation
- Negotiate and approve the EU budget
- Sign off on international agreements
- Approve the members of the European Commission
- Provide oversight of the commission and other EU institutions
- Unable to propose legislation

Source: European Union.

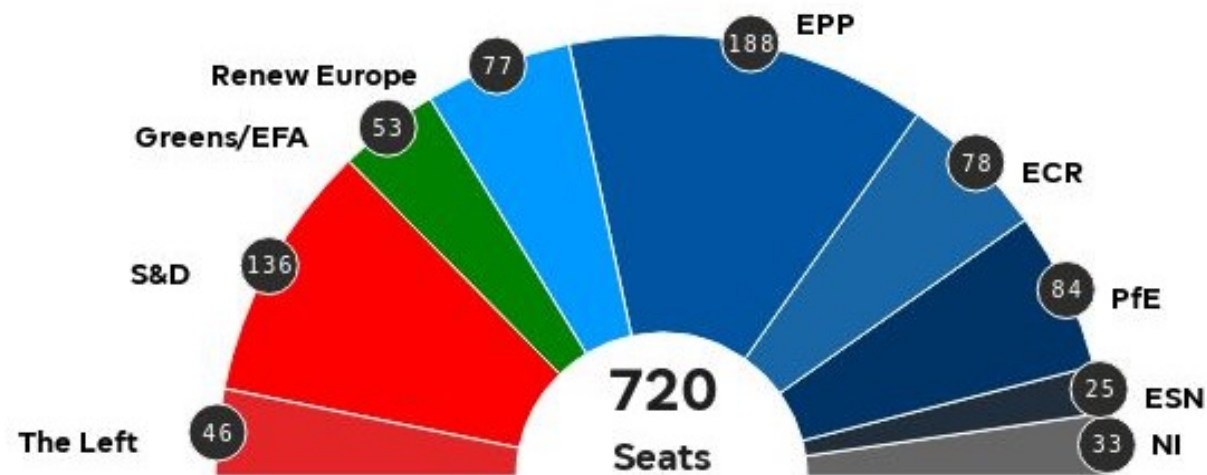
COUNCIL *on*
FOREIGN
RELATIONS

European Parliament 2024 elections

Source: <https://results.elections.europa.eu/en/european-results/2024-2029/>

European Parliament 2024-2029

Constitutive session



How does the EU work?

1. Exclusive competences/common policies
e.g. agriculture, fisheries, trade, internal market
2. Shared competences/common and national policies
e.g. environment, transport, consumer protection
3. Complementary competences
e.g. education, culture, health, industry
4. Intergovernmental
CFSP

On the basis of subsidiarity and proportionality

Principles of Proportionality and subsidiarity

- [Article 5](#)(4) of the Treaty on European Union. It seeks to set actions taken by European Union (EU) institutions within specified bounds. Under this principle, EU measures:
 - must be suitable to achieve the desired end;
 - must be necessary to achieve the desired end; and
 - must not impose a burden on the individual that is excessive in relation to the objective sought to be achieved (proportionality in the narrow sense).
- **The principle of subsidiarity**, laid down in the Treaty on European Union, defines the circumstances in which it is preferable for action to be taken by the Union, rather than the Member States.

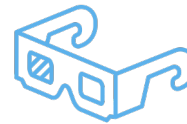
Content



Regionalism why
and How



The European
Union



Theories



Global Europe

The Theoretical Challenge

- Theories of European integration- partial
- **(Neo)functionalism**= focused on creating a theory of EU integration, but did not manage to theorise regional integration
- **Comparative politics, policy analysis** => EU analysed more as political system, policy-making focus on mid-range issues, more empirical research
- **1990s** influence again of IR with CFSP, constructivism and rationalism (Rosamond, 2006:14)
- Legitimacy and democratic deficit

=> **diversity of EU studies**

OF BLIND MEN, ELEPHANTS AND INTERNATIONAL INTEGRATION*

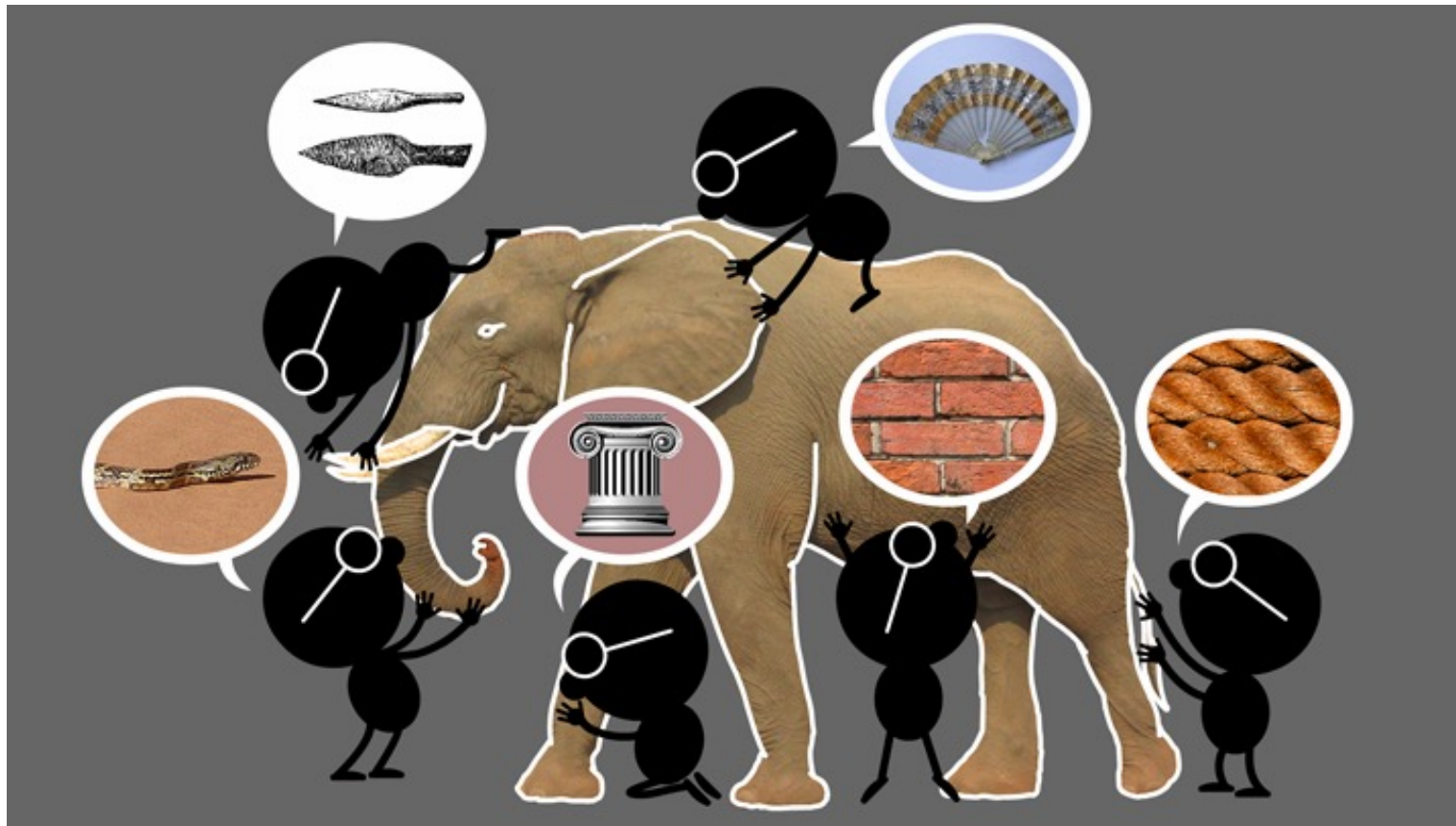
BY DONALD J. PUCHALA

Columbia University

THE story of the blind men and the elephant is universally known. Several blind men approached an elephant and each touched the animal in an effort to discover what the beast looked like. Each blind man, however, touched a different part of the large animal, and each concluded that the elephant had the appearance of the part he had touched. Hence, the blind man who felt the animal's trunk concluded that an elephant must be tall and slender, while his fellow who touched the beast's ear concluded that an elephant must be oblong and flat. Others of course reached different conclusions. The total result was that no man arrived at a very accurate description of the elephant. Yet, each man had gained enough evidence from his own experience to disbelieve his fellows and to maintain a lively debate about the nature of the beast.

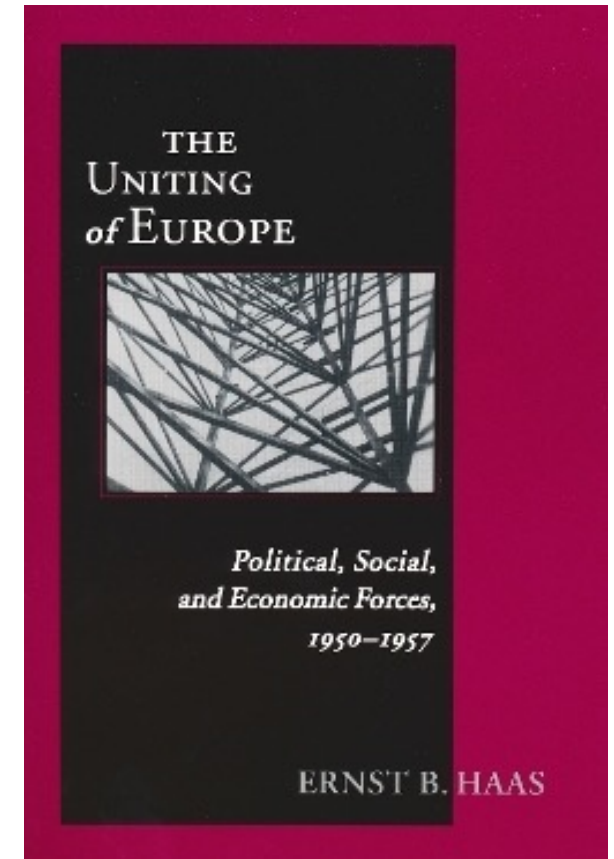
The experience of scholars who have been conceptually grappling with contemporary international integration is not unlike the episode of the blind men and the elephant.¹ More than fifteen years of defining, redefining, refining, modeling and theorizing have failed to generate satisfactory conceptualizations of exactly what it is we are talking about when we refer to 'international integration' and exactly what it is we are trying to learn when we study this phenomenon. Part of the problem stems from the fact that different researchers have been looking at different parts, dimensions or manifestations of the phenomenon.²

Puchala



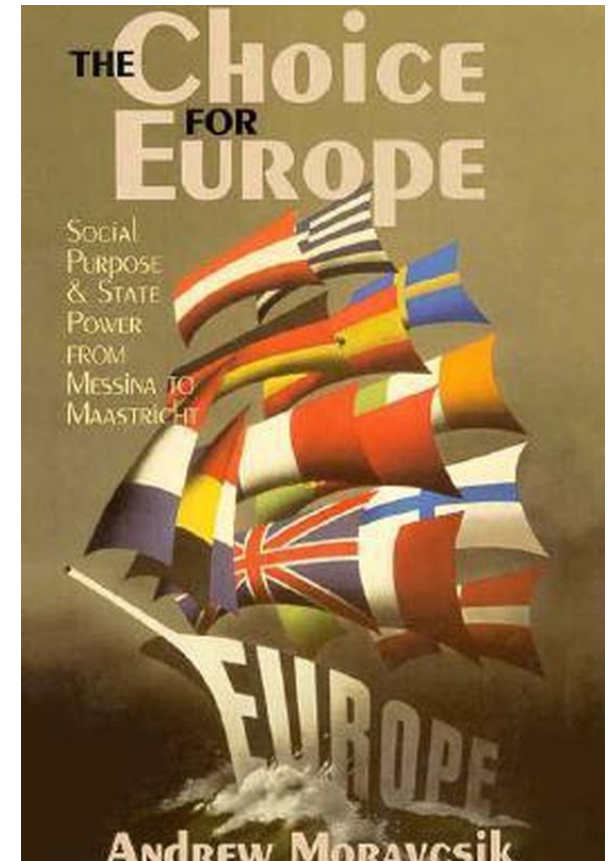
Neo-functionalism

- Functional spill-over & political spill-over
- Economic integration should lead to political integration
- Conceptualization of Community method of policy-making
- A 'procedural code conditioning the expectations and the behaviour' of the actors in EU policy-making process (Pollack, 2011:18)
- Technocratic process



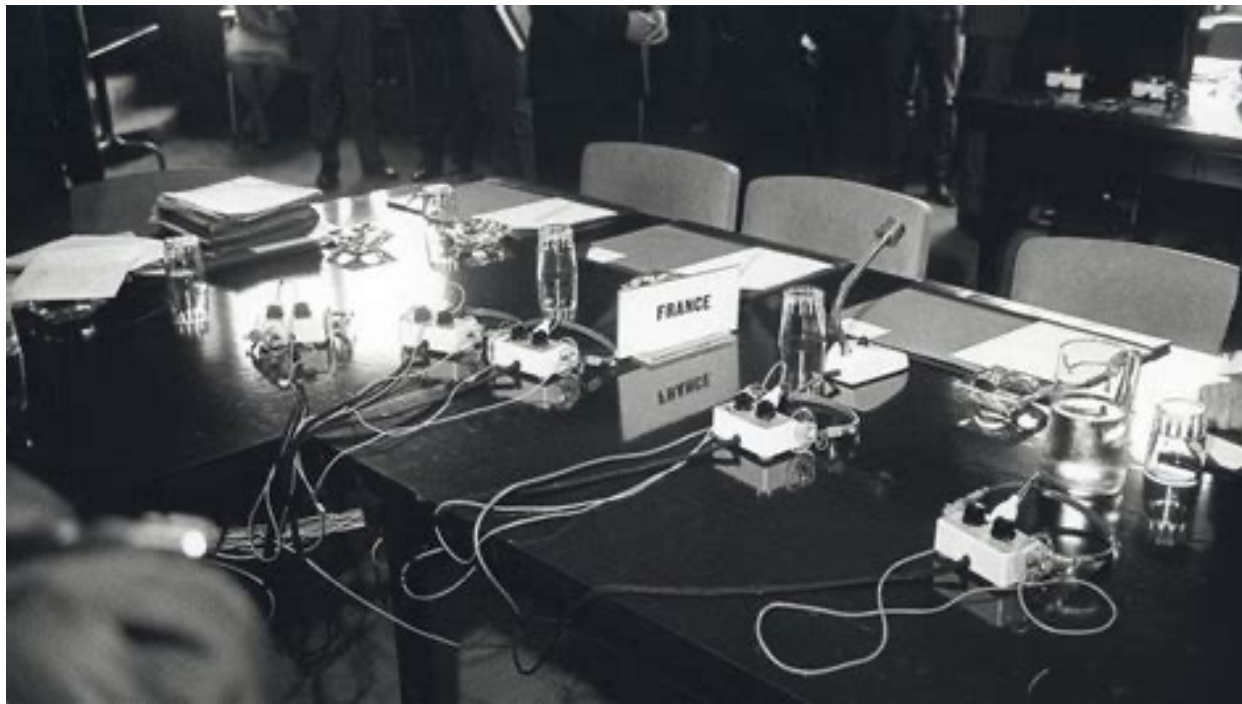
Liberal intergovernmentalism

- The nation-state is obstinate (Hoffman, 1966)
 - The EU has strengthened the NS (A. Milward, 1993)
 - Liberal intergovernmentalism (Moravcsik, 1993) ID of national preference formation, Inter-governmentalism bargaining and credible commitment
 - Actors have rational and fixed preferences
-
- **Economic factors (Moravcsik, 1998)**
 - Franco-German deal preceded the fall Berlin Wall
 - EMU driven by German economic interest (Deutschemark high was reducing
 - competitiveness of German exports)
 - Cost of reunification strengthened that economic interest



The Empty Chair Crisis

https://multimedia.europarl.europa.eu/en/video/history-the-empty-chair-crisis_V001-0005



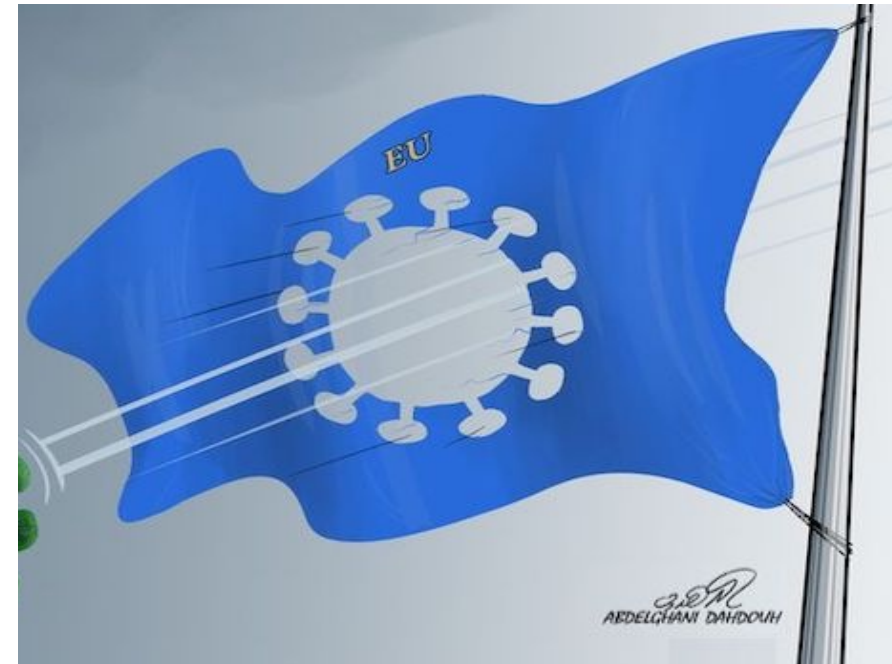
Crisis, Covid-19 and Coordinative Europeanisation

- Coordinative reflexes forged during Covid-19
- Demonstrating agility
- **Inter-crisis learning** is one of the mechanisms enabling transformation and innovation.

i.e. European Semester, Temporary Protection Directive

- Different relationship with EU **MS, more ownership**, part of the solution; Greek NRRP

Wolff and Ladi, 2021



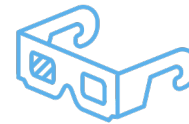
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Regionalism why
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The European
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Theories



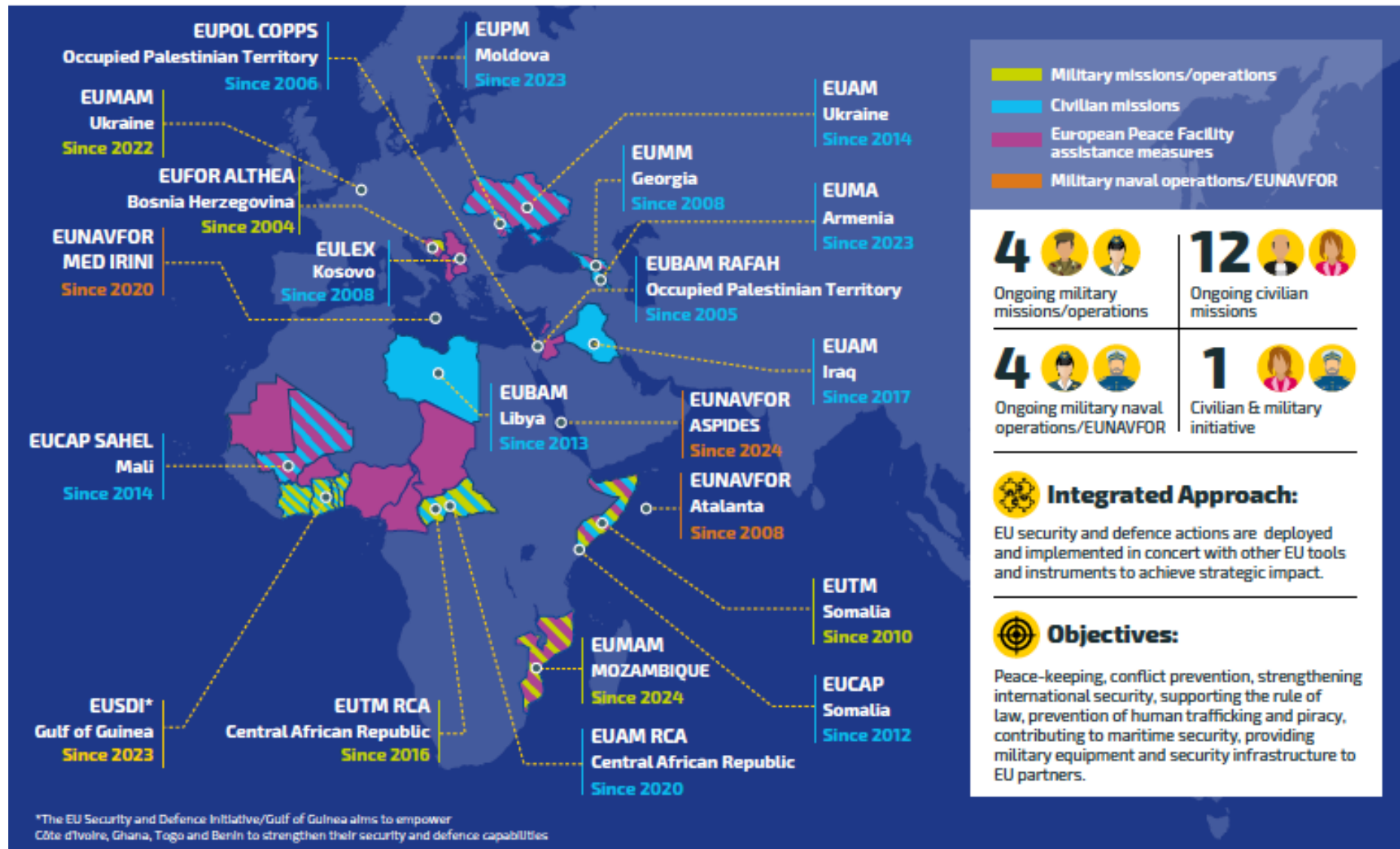
Global Europe

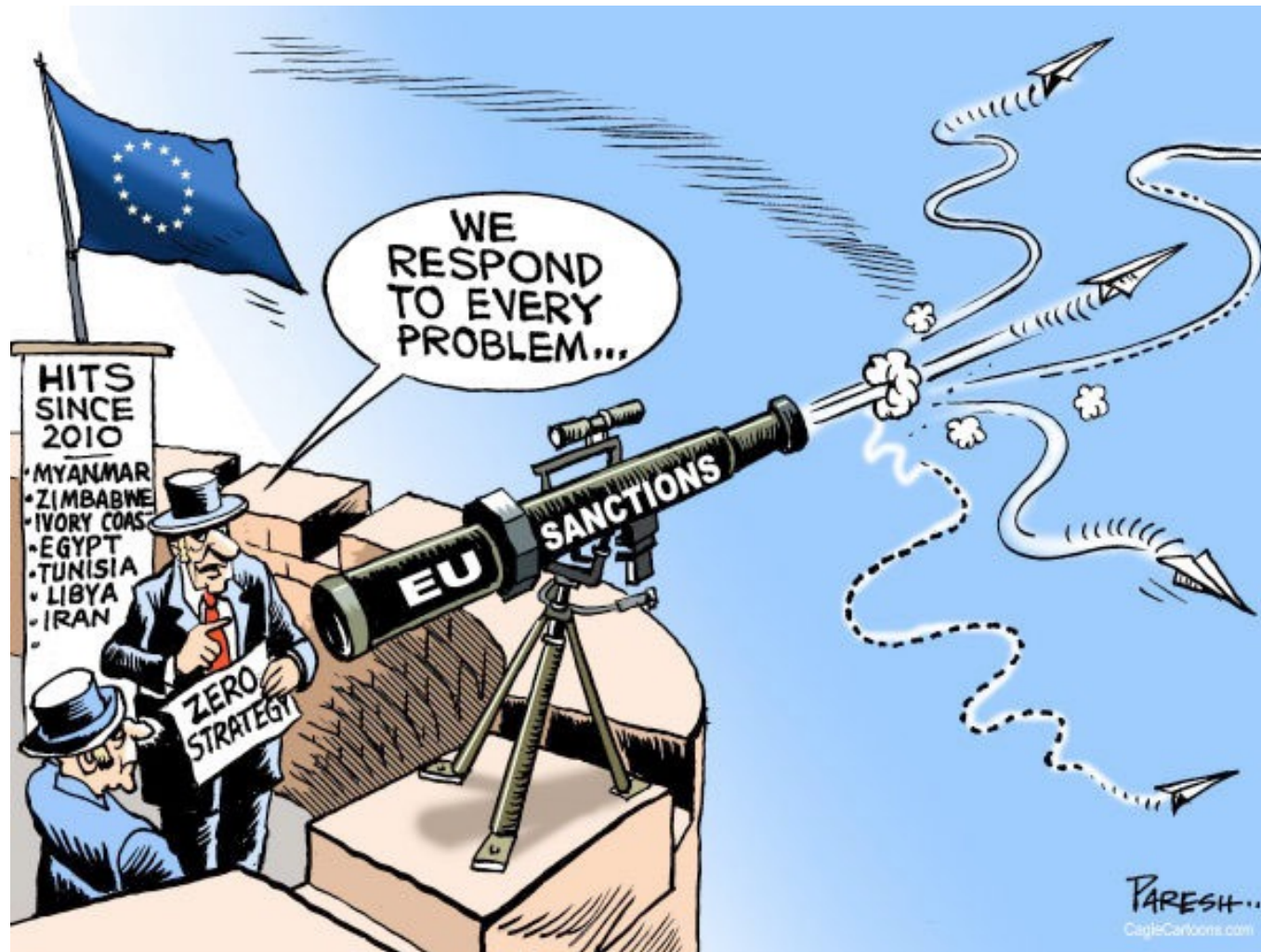
The nature of EU's global power



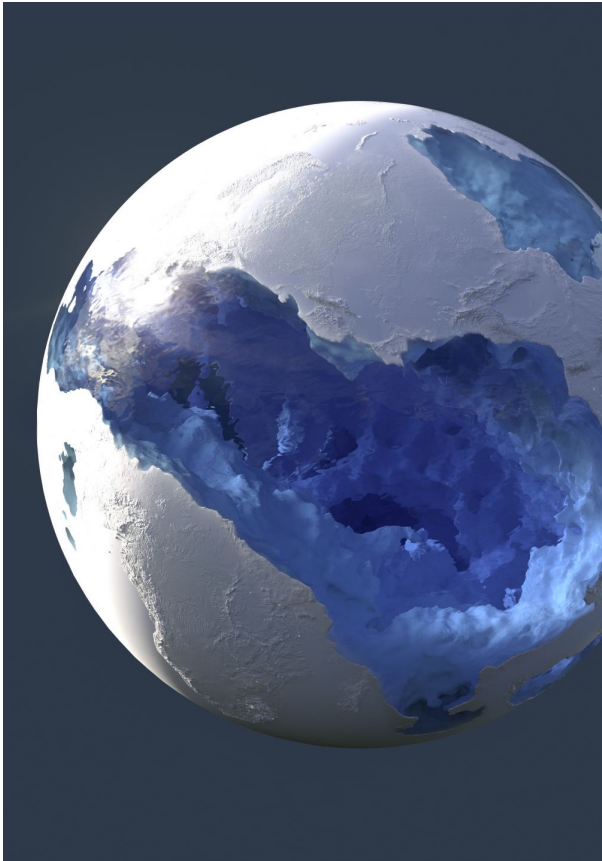
Internal EU challenges: Institutions

CFSP/ CSDP (issues of war and peace)	External policy Exclusive EU competence	External policy Shared or complementary EU competence
E.g. Position on Iran's nuclear programme	E.g. Common Commercial Policy	E.g. Transport, Culture
Common position consensus	Mandate Council QMV	Mandate Council consensus
HR & EEAS represent EU EU delegation	European Commission represents EU EU delegation	Rotating Presidency, HR or Commission? Embassy or EU delegation?
EP consulted	EP assent int agreement needed	EP assent int agreement needed or no EU ratification?



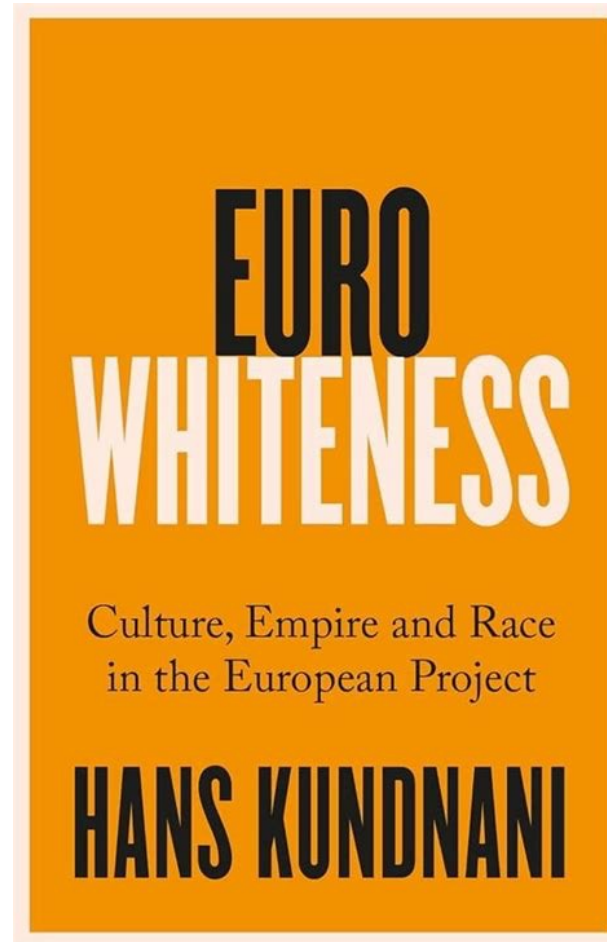


The added-value of decentring (IR)



- It raises the debate on Eurocentrism and the practices of **geopolitical othering** that orientalises other parts of the world (Borg and Diez, 2016:145).
- However so far, it has mostly remained circumscribed to a **post-colonial critique**, or other disciplines such as political theory or sociology (Kinnvall, 2016a, Jabri 2014, Chakrabaty, 2007, Bahbba 1994) and has not been embraced by European studies.
- Decentring comes from an IR perspective that involves '**mutual engagement**', '**self-reflexivity**' ('acknowledging that one always speaks from somewhere') as well as a 'radical decentring' which is about 'acknowledging the centrality of those speaking from elsewhere, wherever your 'elsewhere' happens to be' (Nicolaidis, 2020: 24)
- **Post-Western world**-> Why should Europe (or the United States) be the core referent if you study, say, constitutionalism? Why can't you reverse the gaze and start with the transformative constitutionalisms of South Africa or India and ask what these experiences tell us about European constitutionalism?

Conclusions



Week 10, May 04 – Nation, Race, and Gender (Denney)

Heywood, A., & Whitham, B. (2023). *Global politics* (3rd ed., Chapter 8: Nations and nationalisms in a global age; and Chapter 9: The global politics of identity, difference, and culture). London: Red Globe Press.

Nagel, J. (2022). Masculinity and Nationalism - Gender and Sexuality in the Making of Nations. In *Nations and Nationalism* (pp. 110–130). Edinburgh University Press.

Thank you!



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